might and if: what Murphy does not tell you

Day 2 · Grammar beyond Murphy

Murphy first
Murphy red, Unit 29 (pages 68–69): *might*. Do **29.1, 29.2** in class, **29.3** at home. Unit 99 (pages 208–209): *if*. Do **99.1** in class, **99.2, 99.3** at home. Unit 98 (page 207): **98.3** at home (the present after when / until / before). **99.4** is for fast students on Day 3.
This file adds five things the book does not explain.

1 · The certainty scale

100% It **will** rain. · **plan** We **are going to** stay. · **50%** It **might** rain. · **small chance** It **might not** rain. · **0%** It **won't** rain.
With words: **definitely** · **probably** · **maybe** · **perhaps** · **I'm not sure, but...**

2 · maybe / perhaps / might

Maybe it will rain. = **Perhaps** it will rain. = It **might** rain.
maybe and perhaps are at the **beginning**; might goes **before the verb**. ✗ It ~~maybe~~ rain. ✗ He ~~might to~~ come. ✗ It ~~mights~~ rain (no -s).

Do not mix: Maybe it might rain (too much).

3 · Four kinds of main clause after if

will: *If you hurry, you'll catch the bus.* **might**: *If it rains, we might stay home.*
can: *If you're free, you can come.* **imperative**: *If you see Ali, tell him to call me.*

After if: the present (never will). In the other half: will, might, can or an order.

4 · unless = if ... not

Unless *you hurry, you'll miss the bus.* = *If you don't hurry, you'll miss the bus.*
We'll go for a walk ***unless*** *it rains.* = if it doesn't rain.

After unless the verb is positive: ✗ unless you don't hurry.

5 · The Russian trap

«Если завтра будет дождь, мы останемся дома» → *If it* ***rains*** *tomorrow, we* ***will stay*** *home.* ✗ If it will rain.
«Может быть, он придёт» → *Maybe he will come. / He might come.* ✗ Maybe he might come? (too much)
«Пока ты не придёшь, я буду ждать» → *I'll wait* ***until*** *you come.* (Murphy 98.3)

Practice

Day 2 · Practice 1

What to do: Exercises 1–2 in class, alone, then check. Exercise 3: the class translates aloud, one sentence each.

1 might or will? Choose

1. I (might / will) go to the cinema tonight, but I'm not sure.
2. Take an umbrella. It (might / will) rain.
3. The sun is shining. I am sure we (might / will) have a nice day.
4. She (might / will) not come: she is very busy.
5. Look at those clouds! It (is going to / might) rain!
6. I (might / will) buy a new phone, but the old one still works.
7. Don't worry. I (might / will) help you: I promise.
8. He (might / will) be at home, but I don't know.

2 Make if-sentences

1. (you / hurry) → (you / catch the bus) ____
2. (it / rain) → (we / stay at home) ____
3. (you / be tired) → (go to bed) ____
4. (I / see Ali) → (I / tell him) ____
5. (you / not study) → (you / fail the exam) ____
6. (she / call) → (I / answer) ____

3 Translate into English

1. Может быть, завтра будет дождь.

2. Если ты поторопишься, ты успеешь на автобус.

3. Я, возможно, куплю новый телефон.

4. Если ты увидишь Али, скажи ему, чтобы он позвонил.

5. Мы пойдём гулять, если не будет дождя.

6. Он может не прийти.

7. Если у меня будет время, я схожу в музей.

Practice 2

Day 2 · Practice 2

What to do: Alone, then read your sentences aloud.

4 What might happen? Write 8 sentences

Choose a situation: *a new artist paints a wall in your street | you move to a new apartment | you visit a big museum*. Write what might happen and what you will do if it happens: *If the neighbors like the painting, they might ask her to paint more walls.*

5 Complete the dialogue: might, will or the present

A: What (1 you / do) _____ on Saturday?

B: I'm not sure. I (2 might / go) _____ to the art museum.

A: If you (3 go) _____, I (4 come) _____ with you.

B: Great! If it (5 rain) _____, we (6 take) _____ a taxi.

A: Unless the tickets (7 be) _____ too expensive. B: I think they (8 not / be) _____ too expensive for students. A: Maybe my neighbor (9 come) _____ with us. He is a painter. B: If he (10 come) _____, he (11 explain) _____ everything. Let's ask him!

Answers · Day 2 grammar

For the teacher

1 might · might · will · might · is going to · might · will · might

2 If you hurry, you'll catch the bus. · If it rains, we'll stay at home. · If you are tired, go to bed. · If I see Ali, I'll tell him. · If you don't study, you'll fail the exam. · If she calls, I'll answer.

3 Maybe it will rain tomorrow. · If you hurry, you will catch the bus. · I might buy a new phone. · If you see Ali, tell him to call me. · We will go for a walk unless it rains. · He might not come. · If I have time, I will go to the museum.

4 Own answers: check the present after if (If the neighbors like it, they might...).

5 are you going to do · might go · go · will come · rains · will take · are · won't be · might come · comes · will explain